

[Report 029] GitLab - Program Manager - London

Score: 3.1/5

Culture Fit: Moderate

URL: <https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/gitlab/jobs/8481626002>

PDF: 

Legitimacy: High Confidence

Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)

Date: 2026-05-21

A) ROLE SUMMARY

Field	Detail
Archetype	Technical AI PM (hybrid) - Professional Services Program Manager (customer-facing delivery)
Domain	DevSecOps platform (GitLab), enterprise professional services
Function	Manage - oversee multi-workstream customer programs, stakeholder alignment, delivery methodology
Seniority	Mid-senior (individual contributor PM; reports to Regional Delivery Manager)
Remote	Remote, United Kingdom only
Team size	Not specified; works across multiple customer engagements and internal teams
TL;DR	Customer-facing program manager embedded in GitLab Professional Services - oversees enterprise customer transformation programs, builds delivery methodology, manages stakeholder expectations across long-running multi-workstream engagements.

Critical location flag: Posted as "Remote, United Kingdom." Christiaan is based in Baarn, Netherlands. GitLab is known for being an all-remote company, which is encouraging - but the explicit "United Kingdom" designation raises the question of whether this role is UK-entity-only for tax/legal reasons or genuinely open to EU. This requires verification before investing time. See scoring note.

B) MATCH WITH CV

Requirements vs CV mapping

JD Requirement	CV Match	Strength
Lead delivery across multi-workstream professional services engagements	COVID-19 mega project (8 courses → 1 integrated sprint); Windesheim cross-lectoraat coordination; VCH cross-European initiative	Strong - multi-stakeholder, multi-workstream delivery is core to Christiaan's career
Build relationships with customer stakeholders including executives	KONGSBERG (BP, Statoil - enterprise technical delivery + executive escalation); Windesheim (university management, faculty, external partners)	Strong - enterprise and institutional stakeholder management both documented
Develop delivery methodology using agile and project management best practices	15+ years agile practitioner; Scrum school-wide implementation at Aeres; Prince2, ITIL, Scrum, PSPO I certified	Very strong - methodology building is explicitly in CV multiple times
Build and communicate program roadmaps, dependencies, deliverables	COVID-19 mega project (mapped 8 course dependencies); Spark! Living Lab (Jan 2020-present, ongoing program management)	Strong
Manage stakeholder expectations and gain approval on project milestones	Every project: Windesheim faculty, blockchain community, startup co-founders, grant bodies	Strong
Define program strategy including justification, benefits, scope, timeline, resources	VCH initiative: defined cross-European scope and research agenda; Tonomy: structured org to scale independently	Moderate-strong

Create program-level RACI charts and Work Breakdown Structures	Prince2 and ITIL training covers these explicitly; applied in project delivery roles	Moderate - certified, but no specific RACI example in CV
Forecasting and reporting metrics	DevOps monitoring (Nagios, Grafana); BI dashboard design at KONGSBERG; applied research reporting at Windesheim	Moderate
Budget and timeline management	Grant writing (€2M facilitation); lab budget management (self-funded AI stack); COVID project constraints	Moderate - indirect budget management, not direct P&L
GitLab Project Management Certification within 2 months	Not held; new requirement upon hire	Not a blocker (learn-on-hire)

Gaps

Gap	Blocker?	Mitigation
UK-only remote restriction	Potential hard blocker - must verify if Netherlands is accepted	Contact GitLab recruiter before applying; check GitLab entity structure (they have EU entities)
No professional services delivery background at a SaaS company	Soft blocker - the PS context (delivering against platform implementations) is different from Christiaan's academic/lab context	Frame KONGSBERG field deployments as the closest analog (enterprise client, technical delivery, on-site)
No GitLab platform experience	Soft blocker - certification required within 2 months	Learn quickly; Christiaan has DevOps background (GitHub CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes) so GitLab is adjacent
No formal SaaS customer success or PS track record	Soft blocker	Innovation lab → professional services is a career transition; needs explicit bridge in CV
Full-time position vs. Christiaan's part-time/fractional target	Structural mismatch - score impact	GitLab is known for async remote culture; may be open to non-standard arrangements but no evidence in JD

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Senior individual contributor PM (no reports mentioned; reports to Regional Delivery Manager; manages customers not headcount)

Christiaan's natural level for this archetype: Mid-senior. The program management credentials and agile depth are genuine and senior. The PS SaaS context is the missing bridge.

"Sell senior without lying" plan:

- Lead with the agile transformation track record: "School-wide Scrum implementation at Aeres - merged 8 courses into one sprint cycle in under 2 months." This is the same skill applied to a different domain.
- KONGSBERG is the best analog for PS delivery: enterprise client, multiple sites, technical delivery, executive escalation (CEO contact on data breach). Frame it as professional services delivery.
- Prince2 + ITIL + Scrum Master + PSPO I certification cluster shows methodology depth - covers the GitLab PS certification gap.
- Frame the missing SaaS context as domain, not capability: "The program management skills are proven. I'm learning the GitLab platform context - I'll have the certification in week 4."

"If they downlevel me" plan:

- Mid-level PS PM role at GitLab is still a credible engagement. Accept if comp is fair (€65k+). Negotiate 6-month review. Clear promotion criteria.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

Metric	Estimate	Source
Market range (Program Manager, GitLab PS, remote)	£55,000-£85,000 (approx. €65,000-€100,000)	Glassdoor GitLab PM roles; GitLab is known for transparent compensation

UK)		bands
GitLab compensation reputation	Competitive total comp (base + equity); strong benefits; known for above-average PTO and async culture	Industry data
Christiaan's target range	€65,000-€90,000	_profile.md
Fit	Good alignment - mid-range of GitLab's band matches Christiaan's target	

Note: GitLab publishes compensation calculator on their careers site. Worth checking before applying to confirm the NL entity rate if applicable.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	Section	Current	Proposed change	Why
1	Professional Summary	Lab builder / educator	Add line: "Certified in Prince2, ITIL, Scrum, and PSPO I - applied across complex multi-stakeholder programs from university transformation to cross-European research initiatives."	Maps directly to PS program management context
2	KONGSBERG section	Listed as BI deployments	Reframe as professional services delivery: "Enterprise client-facing technical delivery across BP (Jordan, Oman) and Statoil - managed stakeholder expectations, on-site delivery, and escalation paths in high-stakes environments"	Closest direct analog to GitLab PS
3	COVID-19 mega project	Brief bullet	Expand: "8-workstream program: defined RACI, managed 8 faculty stakeholders, delivered on schedule under pandemic constraints"	Demonstrates exactly the multi-workstream PM the JD describes
4	Certifications	Listed flat	Group PM certs prominently: Prince2, ITIL, Scrum, PSPO I - add "GitLab Project Management Certification (in progress)"	Shows certification culture alignment
5	GitLab / DevOps literacy	Not explicitly named	Add GitLab to DevOps toolset if used (or note familiarity)	Shows platform adjacent experience

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD Requirement	Story	S	T	A	R	Reflection
1	Multi-workstream delivery	COVID-19 mega project	Pandemic disrupted 8 separate university courses simultaneously	Merge into coherent program in 2 months	Mapped dependencies, designed sprint structure using SafeScrum, negotiated with 8 faculty stakeholders	All 8 courses integrated, delivered on time	Earlier stakeholder buy-in conversations would have saved 2 weeks of renegotiation
2	Executive stakeholder management	KONGSBERG CEO escalation	Active oil rig deployment (BP Jordan), data contract breach discovered mid-project, no internet access	Resolve without escalating risk to the client or the contract	Diagnosed the breach, documented it, went directly to CEO - not through chain of command	Issue resolved, contract protected, CEO thanked the proactive escalation	Systematic execution after fast intake - pattern that works in high-stakes delivery
3	Agile delivery methodology	Scrum school-wide at Aeres	School using traditional course delivery, no shared methodology	Implement agile across all programs in under 2 months	Designed the implementation plan, trained faculty, ran first sprint	School-wide Scrum running; still in use after my departure	The "install and leave" test: if a methodology requires me

							to maintain it, I haven't designed it well enough
4	Program strategy definition	Spark! Living Lab	Windesheim needed an innovation vehicle that could operate across departments	Define scope, stakeholders, resources, and a sustainable operating model	Wrote the lab charter, defined the research agenda, recruited students as contributors, aligned with Supply Chain Finance lecture	Jan 2020 to present - 5+ years running	Wish I had defined the success criteria earlier; the open mandate was powerful but made progress hard to communicate
5	Stakeholder expectation management	Tonomy Foundation partner onboarding	External partners had different expectations about product readiness	Manage expectations without losing the partnership	Created a clear roadmap with explicit milestones and "what exists now vs. what is coming" framing	Most partners stayed engaged; one left due to timeline mismatch	Learned that over-promising to keep people happy costs more later than a hard honest conversation now
6	Long-term customer plans	VCH cross-European initiative	No existing framework for SME supply chain AI compliance across EUDR/CSRD/CSDDD	Build a multi-year research and tool development plan	Defined the scope, identified partner institutions, wrote the research agenda, secured Windesheim backing	Running cross-European initiative at valuechainhackers.xyz	The hardest part was saying no to scope additions - every partner wanted to add their priorities

Case study to present: COVID-19 mega project. It is the clearest example of multi-workstream program delivery under constraints. Walk through: the 8 courses, the RACI, the sprint design, the stakeholder negotiations, the delivery.

Red-flag questions:

- "Are you based in the UK?" → "I'm based in the Netherlands. GitLab is an all-remote company with EU entities. I'd want to confirm the hiring entity before proceeding - if this is UK-entity-only for tax reasons, is there a path via a Netherlands entity?" Be direct; don't apply if the answer is no.
- "Do you have professional services experience at a SaaS company?" → "My closest analog is KONGSBERG - enterprise client delivery across multiple sites (BP, Statoil). The tools were different (BI and monitoring systems, not DevSecOps), but the program management pattern is the same: client relationship, delivery methodology, stakeholder escalation. I'd be learning the GitLab PS context, not learning how to deliver programs."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

Signal	Finding	Weight
Posting freshness	Posted April 13, 2026; last updated April 30, 2026 - less than 6 weeks old	Positive
Apply button	Active via Greenhouse	Positive
JD specificity	Named org structure (Regional Delivery Manager), named requirements (GitLab PM cert within 2 months), named deliverables (RACI, WBS, OKRs)	Positive

Requirements realism	Consistent; no impossible experience combinations	Positive
Company hiring signals	GitLab is an established remote-first company with steady professional services hiring; no recent layoff signals in PS department	Positive
Role-company fit	Core to GitLab business model (enterprise PS delivery)	Positive

Caveats: The "Remote, United Kingdom" designation is the one signal that needs clarification - it may indicate UK-entity-only hiring, which would make Netherlands-based candidates ineligible. This is a process question, not a legitimacy question.

H) CULTURE, PERSONALITY & LONG-TERM FIT

H1 - Org Culture Assessment

Stage and type: GitLab is a mature, publicly traded (NASDAQ: GTLB), fully remote company with ~2,000 employees. The culture is exceptional by large-company standards: handbook-driven, async-first, radical transparency, all-remote since founding. The Professional Services team operates within this culture but serves enterprise customers - so the external-facing work has the rhythm of enterprise PS delivery even while the internal culture is remote-first and async.

Culture signals: GitLab publishes its entire company handbook publicly. Decisions are documented, async communication is the norm, there is explicit cultural investment in psychological safety and documentation. The Program Manager role is explicitly a customer-facing IC role with significant autonomy and ownership of customer program outcomes.

Physical/work environment: Fully remote. No office to commute to. The work happens in async digital spaces with periodic customer video calls and occasional travel for customer engagements.

Hackerspace vision match: Moderate. The radical transparency and async culture are genuinely compatible with how Christiaan works. The customer-facing mandate creates variety. But the work is program management within enterprise PS - it is not a build-from-scratch mandate, it is a delivery and methodology mandate. The "small group building new things" dynamic is partially present (GitLab's internal culture is collaborative and values-driven) but the day-to-day work is coordinating enterprise customer programs. Score: 5/10 against the 2-year vision.

H2 - Personality Fit Table

Dimension	What the role requires	Christiaan's profile	Match
Starter vs. finisher	Each new customer program has a start, but the role is primarily delivery/coordination	ENFP-T starter	Moderate - new customer engagements provide starter energy; the delivery phase requires finisher follow-through
Variety vs. repetition	Multiple concurrent customer engagements; varied customer contexts	Thrives on variety	Good match - multi-customer PS work is inherently varied
Autonomy level	High IC ownership of customer programs	Needs ownership	Good match
Build vs. maintain	Build delivery methodology (some building) and coordinate delivery (operations)	Builder identity	Mixed - the methodology building is genuine; the ongoing coordination is maintenance
Fractional fit	Full-time expected	Optimal: 2-3 concurrent 0.4-0.6 FTE	Structural conflict
Energy spike tolerance	GitLab's culture explicitly values async thoughtfulness over real-time energy performance	Front-loaded high energy	Interesting fit: the async culture does not over-reward visible energy, which reduces the misread risk but also reduces the recognition channel
Team size	Multi-customer IC; works with a Regional Delivery Manager	Small team preference	GitLab PS team is relatively small; IC model suits Christiaan

Flags: fractional conflict; starter-finisher risk in sustained customer delivery cycles; UK restriction may be a hard blocker.

H3 - Values & Mission Alignment

GitLab's mission - enabling developers to ship faster and more securely - is intellectually interesting and Christiaan has DevOps and CI/CD background. The "everyone can contribute" open-source ethos has genuine alignment with how he builds.

However, the PS role itself is not about the mission - it is about making enterprise customers successfully adopt the platform. The work is program coordination, not innovation or learning system design. GitLab as an environment is values-aligned; the specific work is operationally oriented.

This is not purely transactional - GitLab's culture generates genuine community and meaning in the work. But the day-to-day is customer program delivery, not the frontier exploration or lab building that drives intrinsic motivation.

Verdict: Moderate alignment. GitLab the company is values-compatible; the PS program manager role is not intrinsically motivating at the mission level.

H4 - Energy Analysis

Energizers:

- Multi-customer variety: each program brings a new set of stakeholders and delivery challenges
- GitLab's radical transparency culture: aligns with how Christiaan works (document everything, share context freely)
- Agile methodology mandate: designing and implementing delivery methodology is genuine building
- Customer-facing delivery: the human interaction component (executive stakeholders, customer teams) provides energy
- Full remote with no commute: optimizes for output, not presence
- GitLab's culture explicitly values thoughtful people who document and reason well - Christiaan's writing ability and systems thinking are recognized assets

Drains:

- Full-time exclusivity: blocks the multi-engagement model
- UK restriction risk: if the role is UK-entity-only, the Netherlands base is a hard stop
- Sustained delivery coordination: after the initial methodology build, the role becomes coordination cycles with customer programs - finisher mode
- No build-from-scratch mandate: program management within PS is not building a new product or lab
- GitLab is a mature company: the "new territory" element is limited within an established PS function

H5 - 18-Month Durability Test

Rating: Plateau risk after methodology build phase

The first 6-12 months would involve building delivery methodology and learning the GitLab PS context - this has builder energy. After the methodology is established, the role becomes execution: managing customer programs against the methodology. This is valuable work but transitions into finisher mode. The multi-customer variety extends the plateau point relative to a single-customer role, but the fundamental work becomes coordination rather than creation.

GitLab's culture would make the experience more pleasant than the plateau implies - the radical transparency and documentation culture means the work is always legible and valued. But the energy trajectory trends downward over 18 months.

H6 - Personality-Specific Red Flags

Red flag	Present?	Severity	Context
Role is primarily maintenance/ops	Partial	Medium	Delivery coordination is the core work after the methodology build
Solo sales of an unready product	No	N/A	Not a sales role
Full-time exclusivity expected	Yes	Medium	Full-time with GitLab; fractional not indicated
Large corporate, slow decision cycles	Partial	Low	GitLab is mature and publicly traded; PS delivery has its own pace but GitLab culture keeps things moving
Ceremony-only role	No	N/A	Not applicable
Governance in decline	No	N/A	Not applicable

H7 - Fit Verdict

Case FOR: GitLab's culture is a genuine fit - the radical transparency, async-first, documentation-heavy culture aligns with how Christiaan works and thinks. The agile delivery methodology mandate taps real expertise. The multi-customer variety and executive stakeholder management are energizing. GitLab is a values-aligned company that Christiaan would be proud to work for. The program management skills fit is strong and this is the right archetype.

Case AGAINST (watch for): The UK restriction is the first filter - if Netherlands is not eligible, this ends before it begins. Full-time exclusivity conflicts with the fractional model. The day-to-day work trends toward coordination and delivery management over time, not building or innovation. GitLab's culture softens the plateau impact, but the work itself does not have a sustained 0-to-1 mandate. If Christiaan is looking for a building role, this is not it - it is a delivery role in a good culture.

Score cap note: The 3.1/5 score is appropriate. The culture fit is Moderate - better than the pure enterprise PS roles but not as strong as n8n. The score correctly prioritizes the skills match and structural issues; culture fit does not elevate it significantly.

Overall personality/culture fit: Moderate

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

program manager, professional services, multi-workstream, agile, project management, RACI, work breakdown structure, OKR, stakeholder management, DevSecOps, GitLab, customer-facing delivery, roadmap, Prince2, ITIL, Scrum, budget management, executive relationships, program strategy, enterprise customers

JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes

Title: Program Manager - London

Job ID: 8481626002

Requisition ID: 6200

Location: Remote, United Kingdom

Department: Consulting Delivery

Posted: April 13, 2026

Last Updated: April 30, 2026

GitLab is the intelligent orchestration platform for DevSecOps, enabling organizations to increase developer productivity, improve operational efficiency, reduce security and compliance risk, and accelerate digital transformation. The company serves more than 50 million registered users and more than 50% of the Fortune 100.

Role Overview:

Customer-facing position within Professional Services, overseeing customer programs and project portfolios. Reports to Regional Delivery Manager.

Key Responsibilities:

- Lead delivery of multi-workstream professional services engagements with strategic customers
- Build strong relationships with customer stakeholders including executives and engineering teams
- Develop delivery methodology leveraging agile and project management best practices
- Build and communicate program roadmaps, dependencies, and deliverables
- Manage stakeholder expectations regarding project milestones
- Define comprehensive program strategy including justification, benefits, scope, timeline, resources, and stakeholder identification
- Create program-level RACI charts and work breakdown structures
- Establish success criteria and communication plans
- Collaborate with Engagement Managers on scoping larger customer programs
- Assist Regional Delivery Managers in creating quarterly OKRs

Requirements:

- Proficiency with forecasting and reporting metrics
- Ability to lead program-level project management meetings

- Ability to manage interconnected projects, budgets, and timelines
- Experience developing long-term plans with customers and partners
- GitLab Project Management Certification within 2 months of hire

Benefits: Health, finances, and well-being support; flexible paid time off; equity compensation; Employee Stock Purchase Plan; Growth and Development Fund; parental leave.